

Google Maps

Lars and Jens Eilstrup Rasmussen at 'Where 2 Technologies' developed a desktop-based mapping application using C++. Google acquired the company in October 2004 and converted the system into a web-based application. Google also acquired a few geospatial data visualisation and real-time traffic analyser companies and released Google Maps in early 2005. Google Map Maker was developed to enable users to contribute to the mapping database. However, the company discontinued the maker tool in March 2017 and launched Google Local Guides program through which submissions from public are currently being accepted.

Google Maps provides exact satellite imagery and street maps including real-time traffic conditions. It also offers 360 degree panoramic views of streets. With optimal utilization of XML, JavaScript and Ajax, the Google Maps also provides an API using which you can embed maps on third-party websites. Maps makes use of aerial photography captured by aircrafts flying at heights of 800 to 1500 feet and from satellites that are updated regularly. According to estimates, Google Maps is one of the most popular mobile apps among Android smartphone users.

Google continued to add new features to Maps every year based on user feedback. Google added support for Opera and Safari on February 25, 2005 along with Internet Explorer and Mozilla Firefox. In a significant development, Google Maps was refreshed with new satellite imagery globally via Landsat 8, which comprised on over 700 trillion pixels of data. The Android app was updated on February 6, 2017 with real-time traffic data enhancements including the recommendations feature.

Working

To work with Google Maps, you need to navigate to google.co.in/maps and search for the place or location. You will view a detailed map on the right side with various adjacent places. The menu located on the top left side helps you to view the traffic and terrain related maps for the relevant location. It is possible to contribute a review with relevant images.

Most Android smartphones nowadays come with the Google Maps app pre-installed. After opening the app, you just need to provide the location to retrieve the relevant maps. The Get Directions panel provides four modes of transportation such as driving, train, bus, walking. In addition to that there's an integration of cab services. If you select Train or Bus, you will be able to view a list of all the trains scheduled to depart from